

In this deal, the software giant has made what is believed to be its second biggest acquisition after LinkedIn, for US\$ 7.5 billion in stock. The acquisition is expected to be closed by the end of the calendar year.

GitHub has become an essential and integral part of the open source community. Microsoft acquiring the beloved platform of the developers has raised fears because the Redmond giant had expressed hostility to open source in the past. In 2001, the then CEO Steve Ballmer had said that “Linux is a cancer.” In addition, companies acquired by Microsoft in the past are known to lose their popularity after the acquisition.

GitHub was valued at about US\$ 2 billion in 2015 and it raised around US\$ 350 million. Buying the company for US\$ 7.5 billion is considered to be one of the biggest bets for Microsoft, larger than its US\$ 7.2 billion purchase of Nokia in 2014. Microsoft corporate VP Nat Friedman, founder of Xamarin and an open source veteran, will be the CEO of GitHub. The current CEO of GitHub, Chris Wanstrath, will become a Microsoft technical fellow, reporting to executive VP, Scott Guthrie, to work on strategic software initiatives.

Wanstrath said: “I’m extremely proud of what GitHub and our community have accomplished over the past decade, and I can’t wait to see what lies ahead. The future of software development is bright, and I’m thrilled to be joining forces with Microsoft to help make it a reality.”

Wanstrath went on to add, “Microsoft’s focus on developers lines up perfectly with our own, and its scale, tools and global cloud will play a huge role in making GitHub even more valuable for developers everywhere.”

No one is really sure what this acquisition means for the open source community. Some believe that Microsoft will make GitHub more trusted for use in projects and source control, while some have commented that the company might even add tracking or advertisements to all GitHub sites.

## IBM’s ‘Call for Code’ initiative for developing software to combat natural disasters

IBM and partners like the American Red Cross, the David Clark Cause and the UNHRC have launched the ‘Call for Code’ global initiative, to bring developers from startups, academia and enterprises together for a common cause. Their aim is to solve one of the most pressing societal issues of the time—using tech to prevent, respond to and recover from natural disasters.

IBM president and CEO, Ginni Rometty, called on the technology industry to help build a better future, committing IBM’s technology and US\$ 30 million for the next five years in the annual Call for Code initiative. Chief digital officer, Bob Lord, stated that the power of technologies like AI, blockchain, IoT and the cloud present some of the biggest opportunities and challenges in business at IBM.

Through this global initiative, IBM and its partners will focus on securing the participation of affected groups in improving preparedness, response and recovery efforts during natural disasters.

This is a team effort to bring developers together to mitigate natural disasters.

Call for Code also integrates the on-the-ground work of the American Red Cross, and focuses on new ways to bring support to disaster victims – especially important since IBM’s data has ranked 2017 as one of the worst years on record for catastrophic events, including fires, floods, earthquakes and storms.



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